



**SCHOOL FOR THE GIFTED, GWAGWALADA – FCT
ENGLISH LANGUAGE – SS1 SECOND TERM
TOPIC: VOCABULARY DEVELOPMENT**

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1. Introduction

Vocabulary development is the process of learning, understanding, and correctly using new words in speaking, reading, and writing. A rich vocabulary enables students to express ideas precisely, comprehend texts easily, and perform excellently in examinations.

2. Meaning of Vocabulary

Vocabulary means **the stock of words** a person knows in a language.

It includes:

- words we understand when we read or listen – *receptive vocabulary*,
- words we use when we speak or write – *active vocabulary*.

3. Importance of Vocabulary Development

Good vocabulary helps learners to:

1. understand comprehension passages,
2. write better essays and letters,
3. speak fluent and confident English,
4. avoid vague expressions,
5. communicate like global citizens.

Students of the School for the Gifted are expected to consciously build vocabulary daily for academic excellence.

4. Ways of Developing Vocabulary

a. Extensive Reading

Reading novels, newspapers, magazines, and subject textbooks exposes students to new words naturally.

b. Dictionary Use

A good learner's dictionary shows:

- meaning,
- pronunciation,
- word class,
- example sentences.

c. Learning Word Families

One root can produce many words.

- act – action – active – activate – actor
- nation – national – nationality – nationalism

d. Keeping Personal Word Bank

Students should own a notebook where they record:

- the word,
 - meaning in their own sentence,
 - synonym and antonym.
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5. Methods of Forming New Words**i. Prefixes**

A **prefix** is added before a root.

- happy → unhappy
- possible → impossible
- regular → irregular

Prefixes often create opposites.

ii. Suffixes

A **suffix** is added after a root.

- teach → teacher
 - create → creation
 - beauty → beautiful
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iii. Compounding

Joining two words to make one.

- school + bag → schoolbag
 - note + book → notebook
 - foot + ball → football
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iv. Conversion

Changing word class without changing form.

- water (noun) → to water (verb)
 - phone (noun) → to phone (verb)
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6. Synonyms and Antonyms

Synonyms – words with similar meaning

- big – large – huge
- begin – start
- clever – intelligent

Antonyms – opposites

- tall – short
 - early – late
 - success – failure
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7. Learning Vocabulary through Context

The **context** is the surrounding words that help us guess meaning.

Example:

- *The desert is very **arid**; plants hardly grow there.*
“arid” means dry.

Gifted students must train to infer meanings before checking dictionary.

8. Register in Vocabulary

Register means words related to a field.

School Register

- principal, assembly, hostel, curriculum, laboratory.

Hospital Register (familiar to our community)

- doctor, ward, syringe, diagnosis, patient.

Environment Register

- erosion, pollution, climate, biodiversity.
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9. Vocabulary Categories for SS1

Students should master:

1. academic words,
 2. phrasal verbs,
 3. idioms,
 4. figurative expressions,
 5. commonly confused words.
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Examples

Commonly Confused Words

- affect / effect
- advice / advise
- practise / practice

Phrasal Verbs

- give up – surrender
- look after – care for
- put off – postpone

Idioms

- once in a blue moon
 - a stitch in time saves nine
 - call it a day
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10. Summary

- Vocabulary development is deliberate and continuous.
 - Words are formed through prefixes, suffixes, compounding.
 - Dictionary and reading are major tools.
 - Register and context guide meaning.
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11. Class Exercises

Exercise A – Give meanings

1. diligent
2. innovative
3. pollution
4. postpone
5. hostel

Exercise B – Provide synonyms

- intelligent
- large
- beautiful

Exercise C – Use in sentences

- diagnosis
- arid
- diligent
- look after

Exercise D – Prefix opposites

- possible
- happy
- regular
- legal

Advice to Students:

Learn at least **5 new words every day** and use them in your essays and conversations.